**Yogitha:** Do we have any cultural programme?

**Teacher:** Yes. We are going to open the new building of our school.

**Students:** Yeah! We are going to a new class room!

**Muthu:** Who will be the Chief guest?

**Teacher:** We have invited our MLA as the chief guest for the opening ceremony.

**Rahim:** MLA. I have heard. But I don't know who is he?

**Teacher:** MLAs are representatives of the people. He is one among us. He is the Member of Legislative Assembly.

**Saran:** What is Legislative Assembly? Will you explain in detail?



**Teacher:** Sure. (showing pictures of fort St. George, Assembly session, Chief Minister and other ministers)

**Meena:** What is that building? Where is it? It looks like a fort.

**Teacher:** Yes. You are correct. It is a fort in Chennai. First English fortress in India. The fort currently houses the Tamil Nadu legislative assembly and Secretariat of Tamilnadu.

Legislative Assembly has the lower house where all the MLAs meet to discuss various matters related to the welfare of the state.

**Kayal:** Who will be there in that Legislative Assembly?

**Teacher:** Listen! India has separate system of administration for the Union, States and Union territories. Do you know how many states and union territories are there in India?

**Ravi:** Shall I tell? 28 states and 8 union territories including our capital territory Delhi? Am I right teacher?

**Teacher:** Exactly. As I said already power is divided between two sets of governments one at the central in Delhi and separate governments for all the states. This is called as federal system.



India is a Parliamentary democratic republic where the President of India is the Head of Indian Union and the Prime Minister and all the Ministers are responsible for smooth running of the government. This is called central government.



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